Glashütte, Saxony, 17

14 May 1943

Ma Chère Rose,

When I received a letter from Maître Mallon informing me that you are in Germany with your sister, I could hardly believe it. To have read that you came to help Léa, but also you hoped to find me, makes me realize what a brave young woman you are, willing to endure hardship for others.

I can only imagine how difficult these last months have been. I hope your conditions are better than here in Berlin. I work for Weser Aircraft, where I assemble Stuka dive bombers. There are many barracks at the airport, but I live in one with eighty Frenchmen divided among ten rooms. We are a mix of STOs and former POWs, and you might imagine how well we have come to know one another over these last months. The hours are long and the work is hard, but still, we are the lucky ones, allowed to have beer and lemonade, which is much better than what others have. As I am sure you are aware.

Since I've been in Berlin, we've had a few air alerts warning of British bombers, but none of them serious. Though I'm not allowed to move around freely, I can apply for a day pass to visit the city, which should be granted since I have no marks on record. If you could come here, then we might spend an entire day together or more. There is so much that I'd like to tell you, but I can only share it with you in person.

I trust this letter reaches you safely. I don't know how many barracks are in the town of Glashütte, but I am confident that anyone who has met the beautiful and brave Rose Cotillard will not have forgotten her, and hence my letter will eventually wend its way to you.

Please don't delay in writing back after you receive this, confirming your correct address. I always want to know where you are, Rose.

With much love,